

of the options as possible: the simpler your setup, the less likely you are to have problems. If your software includes a component that runs in the background, you may be asked if you want to run it as a service or an application. Vista and XP treat services differently, so try the 'application' option instead.

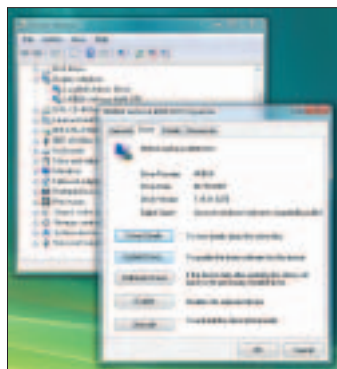
Tip 4

Some programs may not install or run on Vista because there's a conflict with some other part of your system. Simplify the situation by closing all running applications, including all the non-essential apps with icons in your system tray. You could also try installing a program from Safe Mode (reboot your PC > press F8 > choose Safe Mode from the list). This starts Vista with the minimum of drivers and no startup applications, cutting the chance of conflicts to a minimum. Unfortunately, it also blocks many Windows components, and the installation programs that verify serial codes online won't work. But if you're struggling to get a program working, it's worth a try.



Tip 5

Old or buggy device drivers will occasionally prevent programs from running. To check this, run Device Manager (click Start > type `devmgmt.msc` in the Search box > press Enter) and look for devices marked as faulty with a yellow exclamation mark. Double-click on the problem hardware for help. If all seems well there, you could still try updating other drivers yourself. Video drivers are particularly important. Expand the Display Adapters section of the Device Manager tree, double-click on your graphics card and click Driver



to find your current driver version, then click Update Driver to see if Windows can find a later version. This doesn't always work, so you may have to visit your graphics card manufacturer to see if there's a later driver available.

Tip 6

Some pre-Windows 95 software — particularly games — just won't run under Vista. The solution is to con the software into thinking it's running on an ancient PC. Dosbox (www.dosbox.com) is a clever free tool that can emulate Dos (the operating system that came before Windows). You can use it to run old games, such as the original Doom, and it takes care of the video and sound compatibility issues. Freedos (www.freedos.org) is a similar utility with the ability to build bootable Dos CDs (www.fdos.org/bootdisks). If all else fails, you may be able to reboot your system to play a particular game — a minor hassle but better than not being able to run the program at all.

